



www.characterrigs.com

Introduction



Hello, dear friends,

Thank you for using products from character rigs.com! We really appreciate your support! Please enjoy animating our character rigs, and don't hesitate to share your works with the world!

Table of Contents

1. Reference the Rig
2. Install the Control Tool
3. Rig Explanation
 - 3.1. Master Ctrl
 - 3.2. Torso/Neck
 - 3.3. Arm/Leg
 - 3.4. Hand
 - 3.5. Face
 - 3.5.1. Mouth
 - 3.5.2. Eye
 - 3.5.3. Nose
 - 3.5.4. Cheek
 - 3.5.5. brow

Note:

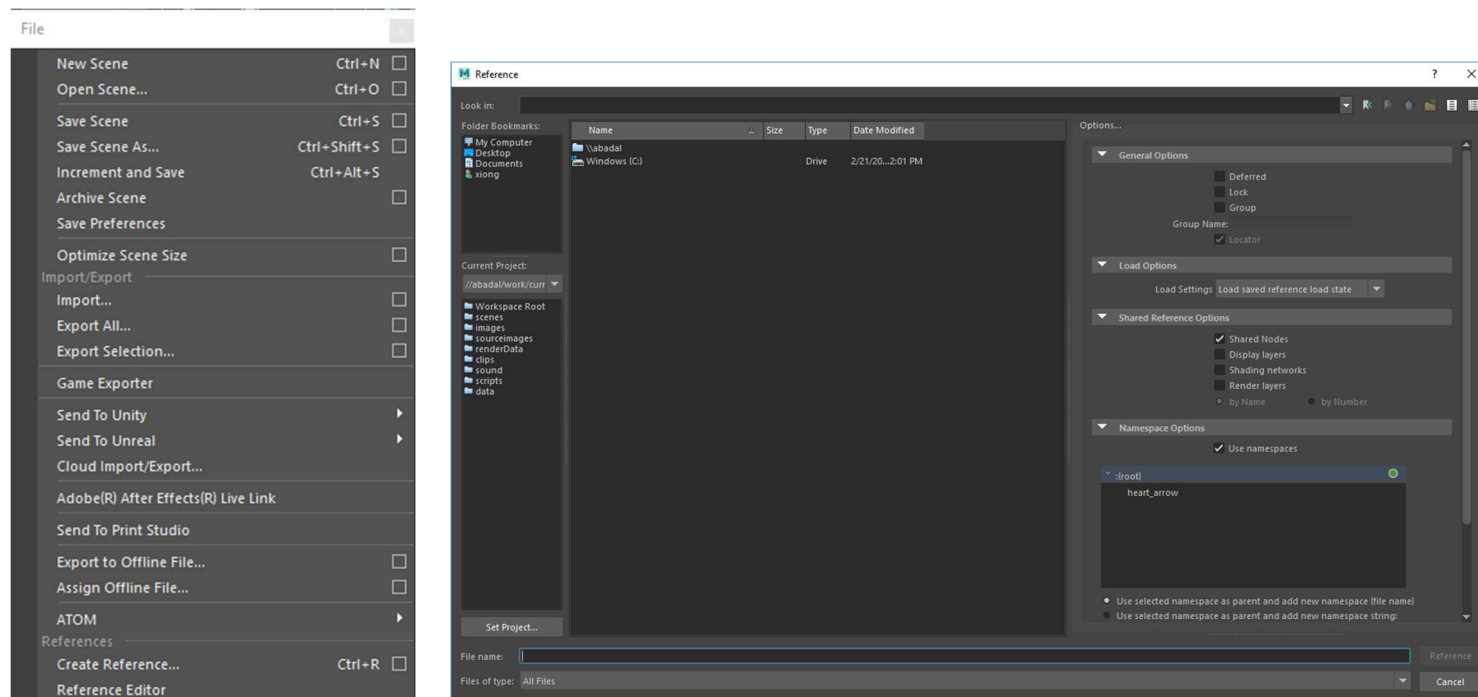
This is a general help document for all our character rigs. The character rig you have might be slightly different. To find the information you need quickly, please use “ctrl + f”.

1

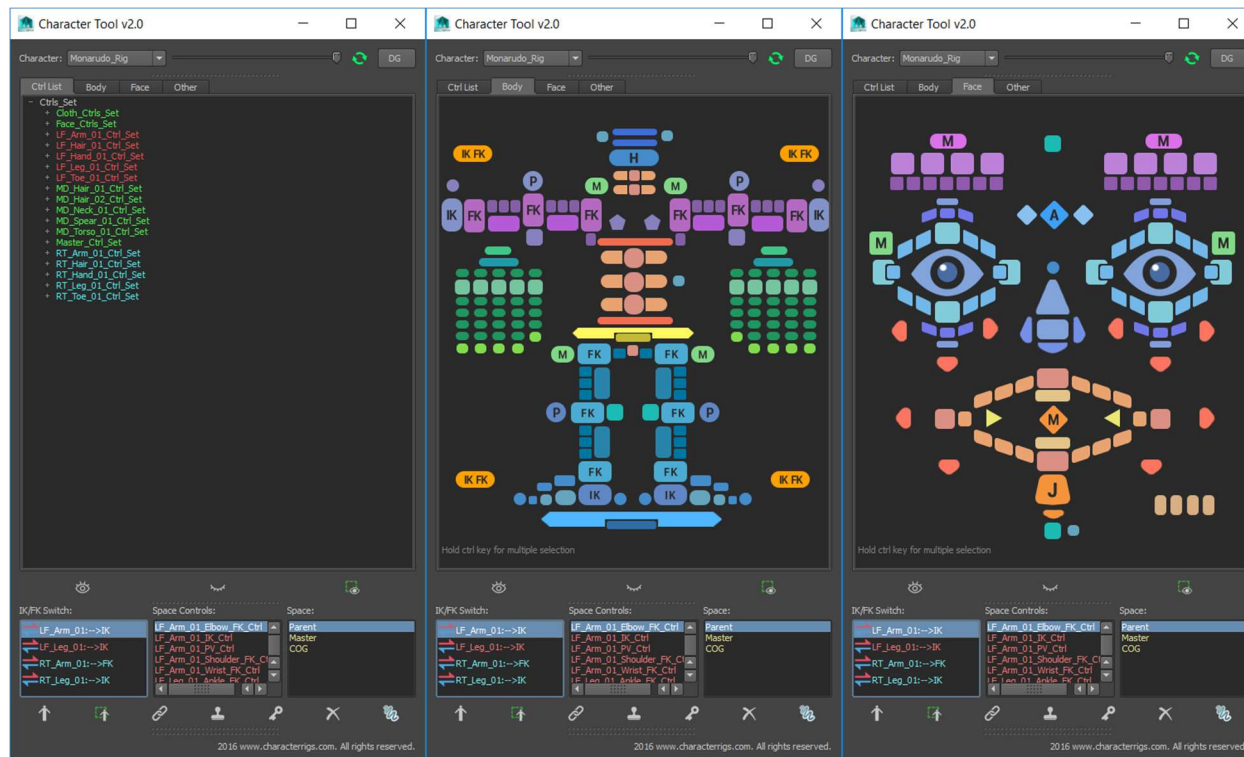
REFERENCE THE RIG

In order to keep the rig file as the original copy, we highly recommend you don't open the file directly in Maya. Instead, we recommend you open an empty scene, and create a reference of the rig file. If you are not familiar with the workflow, here is how you do it.

Check the main menu, then select File -> Create Reference. Or you can simply press the hotkey Ctrl + R. You will see a file browser window. Simply find the rig file, and then click the "Reference" button. Please keep the reference setting as the default. It's very important that you need to turn on the "Use Namespaces" option, otherwise you will not be able to use the character tool.



2 USE THE ANIMATION TOOL



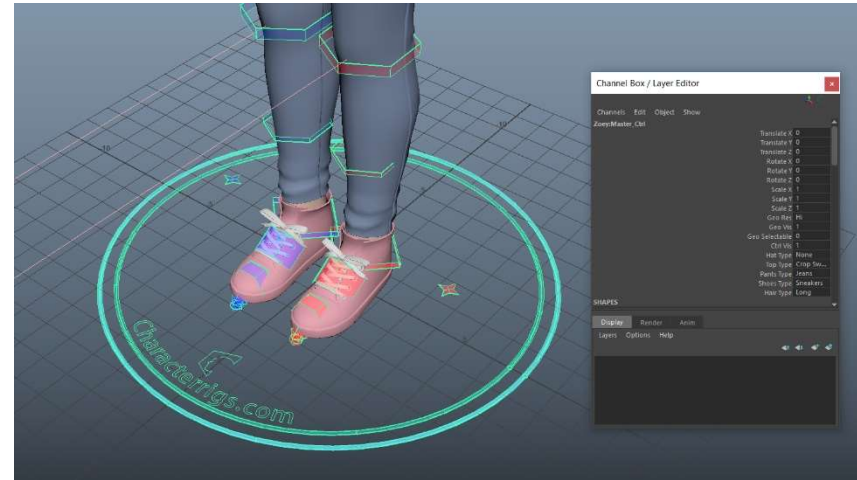
We provide you a powerful animation tool to animate our characters. It's designed only for our character rigs. For more information and get it download, please visit www.characterribs.com/tool.html

3 USING THE RIG

3.1 Master

- Global Scale
- Ctrl Visibility Toggle
- Geo Visibility Toggle

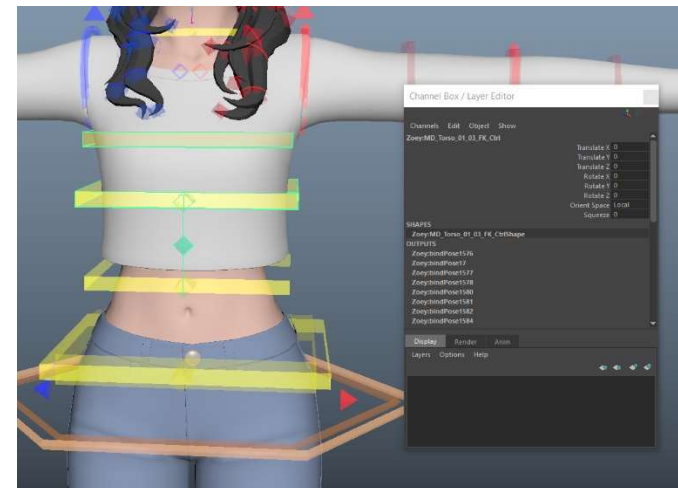
1. Using the “Master_Ctrl”, you can translate, rotate, and scale the whole character.
2. “Geo Selectable” is the attribute that can lock the section of the character polygon.
3. There are also many attributes do visibility toggle and mesh switch.



3.1 Torso/Neck

- FK Controls Chain
- IK Tweak Controls
- Auto Stretch
- Squash and Squeeze

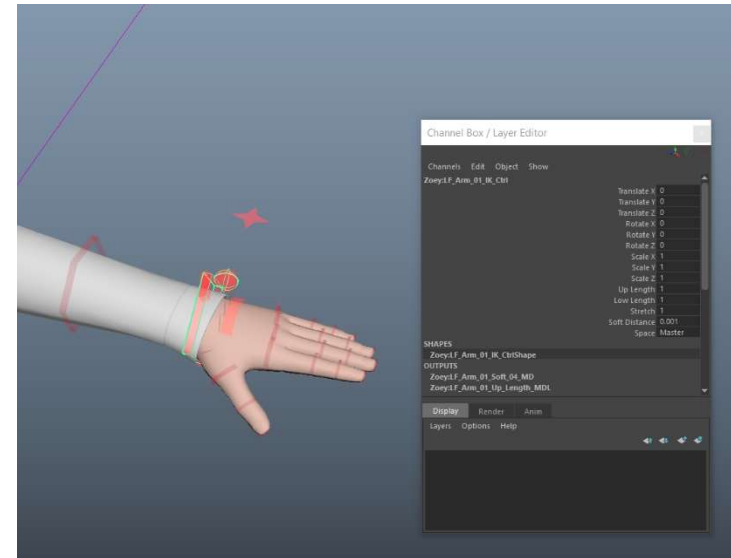
1. The torso and neck are hybrid set up of IK and FK chain.
2. We also provide additional tweak control under each FK control. Each FK control has an attribute called “Orient Space”, which you can change the FK control’s following rotation space. You can use our character tool to do the seamless switch.
3. MD_Torso_01_03_FK_Ctrl has additional attribute called “Squeeze”, which you can use to change the volume of the torso when stretching or compressing it.



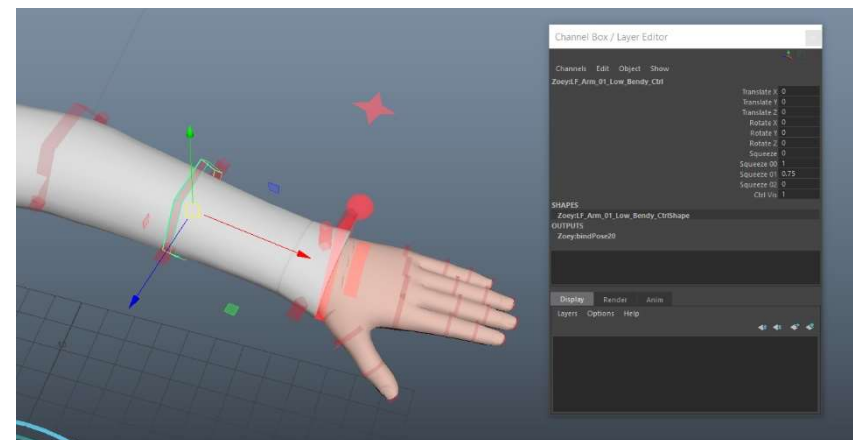
3.2 Leg/Arm

- IK FK Switch
- Auto Stretch
- Squash and Squeeze
- Soft IK
- Elbow Pin
- Bendy Controls
- Foot Rolling System

1. Both the arm and leg can do IK FK switch. You can use our character tool to do the seamless switch.
2. Like the torso, all the arm/leg FK controls have “Orient Space” attribute to do the following rotation space switch.
3. We have a very power full IK set up. You can do space switch, auto stretch, soft IK, changing the arm length, etc.
4. If you need to do soft IK, please turn of the “Stretch” attribute, and set a bigger value of the “Soft Distance” attribute, 0.3 would be a nice value to try.

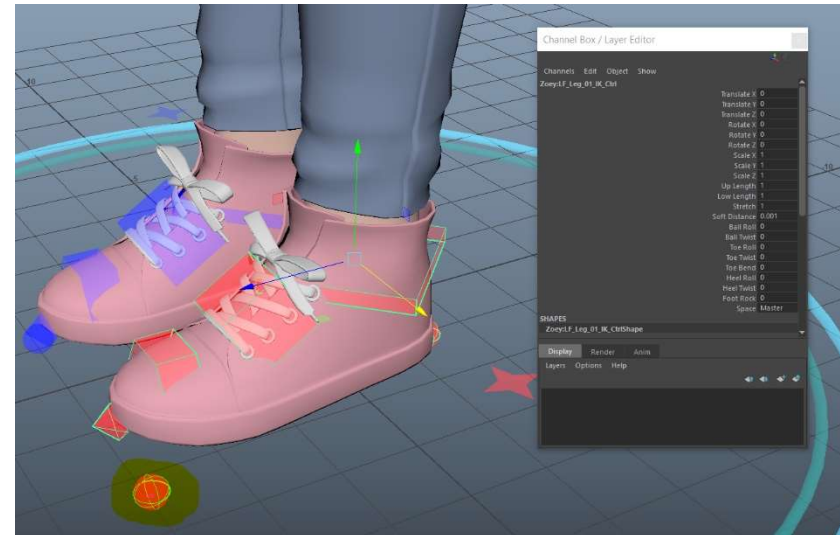


5. If you need to lock of the elbow, please use the “Mid Lock” attribute under “*_PV_Ctrl”.
6. We also providing additional sub controls. They are hidden by default, but you can show them using the “Ctrl Vis” attribute under bendy control.
7. The bendy control also has an attribute called “Squeeze”, which you can use to change the volume of the limb when



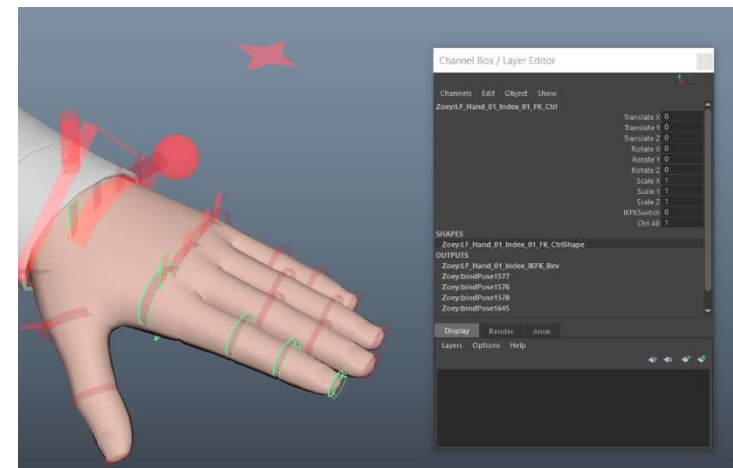
stretching or compressing it. The following attributes “Squeeze 00”, “Squeeze 01”, “Squeeze 02”, are scale factor when doing the volume control.

8. We provide you a very powerful foot rolling system. You can use a list of attributes under the leg IK control to roll the foot. Or, you can use the IK Tilt control to roll the foot. As highlight in the image above, you can change the IK Tilt controls position, and then the tilt pivot will be changed as well.



3.3 Hand

- IK/FK Controls
 - Master Roll
 - Master Spread
1. The first finger control (named as “*_01_FK_Ctrl”) has attribute “IKFKSwitch”, which you can use it to do finger IK FK switch.
 2. The “Ctrl All” attribute is a switch to decide whether the lower level finger FK controls will follow the first finger FK control.
 3. The finger master controls (named as “*_01_Master_Ctrl”) have attribute called “Ctrl Vis” which can toggle the visibility of finger FK controls.

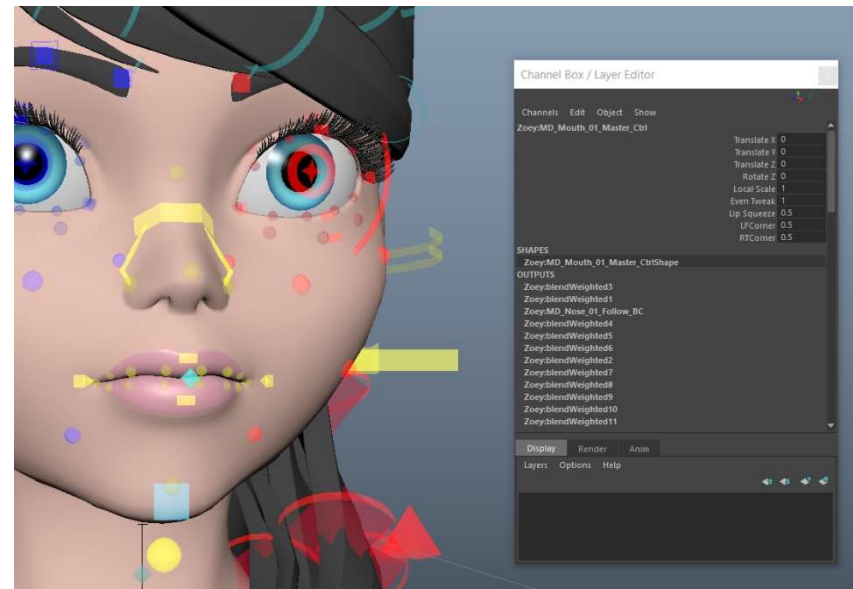


3.4 Face

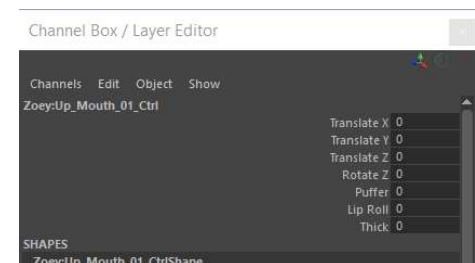
3.4.1 Mouth

- 2 Layers of Controls
- Lip Sewing
- Jaw Colliding
- Lip Corner Shifting

1. We provide you a very intuitive mouth master control to control the mouth easily.
2. “Local Scale” is the attribute that can scale the whole mouth.
3. “Even Tweak” is a switch to decide whether the mouth lips are going to stretch evenly or not.
4. “Lip Squeeze” is a volume scale factor when the lips are stretched or compressed.
5. “LFCorner” and “RtCorner” are switches to decide whether the lip corners are going to follow the upper lip or the lower lip.
6. The “*_LipSew_Ctrl” can zip the upper lip and lower lip.



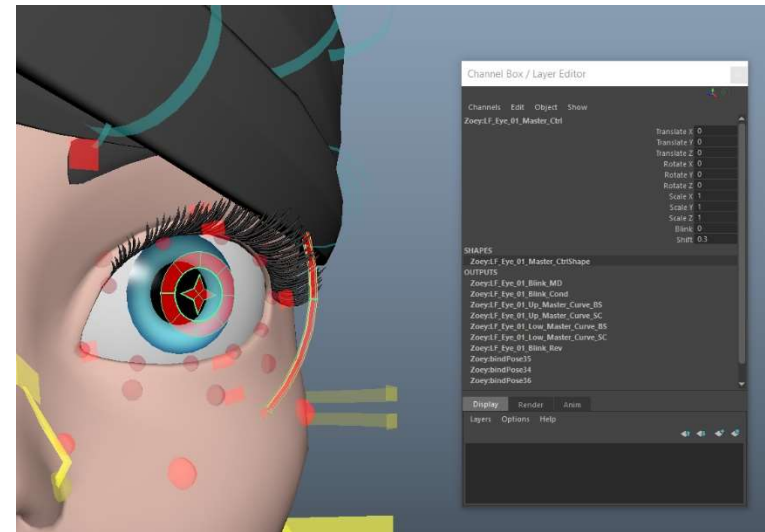
7. Additional attributes under “Up_Mouth_01_Ctrl” and “Low_Mouth_01_Ctrl” can change the shape of the lips.



3.4.2 Eye

- 2 Layers of Controls for Eyelid
- Eyeball, Iris and Pupil Scale
- Aim Ctrl
- Freshy Eyelid
- Eyelid Collide

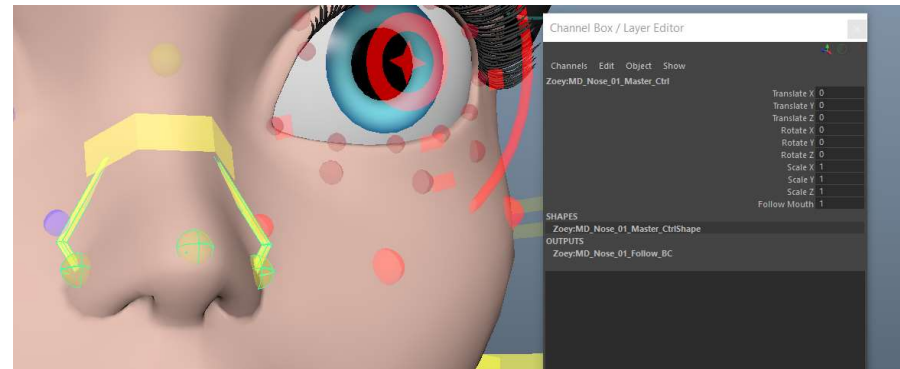
1. You can use the “*_Eye_01_Master_Ctrl” to scale the whole eye and do easy blink.
2. “Shift” is the attribute that can shift the eye lid line when eye is closed.
3. “*_Eye_01_Aim_01_Ctrl” has attribute to toggle the visibility of sub controls and toggle the influence of freshy eye.
4. The attribute “Freshy Eye” means whether the eye lid will follow the rotation of eye ball.



3.4.3 Nose

- Shape Controls
- Auto Offset with mouth movement

The attribute “Follow Mouth” under Nose Master control is a switch to decide whether the nose will follow the movement of the mouth master control.

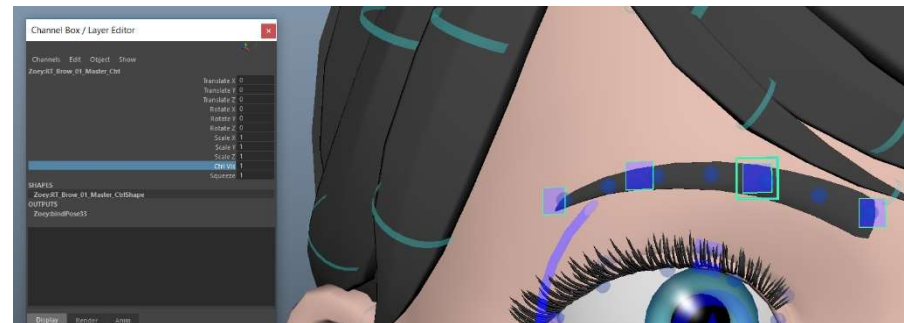


3.4.4 Cheek

- Shape Controls
- Auto Offset with mouth movement

3.4.5 brow

- 3 Layers of Controls
1. The Brow master control has attribute “Ctrl Vis” to toggle the visibility of the sub controls.
 2. You can use the “Squeeze” attribute to change the volume of the brow when stretching or compressing it.



THE END

Please follow our Facebook page <https://www.facebook.com/characterriigs/> to get more information! Thank you.